



Amazon destroys products

Almost 2 million counterfeit products were seized and destroyed by Amazon to prevent resale. <https://digit.in/jul21-39>



\$30,000 bounty for exploit

Facebook awards \$30,000 bounty for an exploit that exposed private Instagram content. <https://digit.in/jul21-40>



Prototyping and testing of the dVerse UVfy tech

Shreyas Prakash, also with a Masters in Integrated Product Design from TU Delft, Netherlands, had served international clients in the field of health-care related product design and was the recipient of iF Design Talent Award 2020, for Equarun, an assistive device for deafblind runners. Sameer Mallik who is an innovation expert whose core experience is in designing and implementing innovation programs for early-stage ventures has been guiding us as a business consultant.

Having a prior background in developing award-winning low-cost medical technologies, we wanted to create technologies to tackle pandemic-related challenges in the healthcare sector.

After talking to doctors across India, we identified the need for a portable sterilizer that addresses common touchpoints, preventing cross-contamination in COVID-19 isolation wards and ICUs. We developed Sterilo and got an opportunity to present our work to researchers across 11 Latin American countries. We emerged as winners of the healthcare track in the Massachusetts Institute of Technology's COVID-19 challenge. With the support of the MIT grant, we proceeded to develop UVfy, an AI-based sterilizer for elevators. Several studies indicated elevators

to be a high-risk transmission point for hospital-acquired infections (HAIs) since they are confined spaces with a lack of adequate ventilation. More than half the medical staff we surveyed were worried about accessing elevators, especially during the pandemic. UVfy makes confined spaces like elevators safer to access for patients and the healthcare staff."

The device was developed, prototyped and manufactured during the pandemic, and the team would have to source the components through fragile distribution channels during uncertain times. The team used much of the tools that all of us did, "for the initial few months,

all of us founders were working from different locations – Bangalore, Chennai, Coimbatore, Netherlands and Delhi. Virtually collaborating to build a tangible product came with its own challenges. How do you communicate and discuss ideas through an audio call? In a physical space, a simple gesture might have done all the talking. How do you create a video or a 3D model or a prototype virtually? How do you build a sense of team in a virtual environment? While we are still on our quest of finding answers to these questions, we create virtual co-working spaces and use tools like Figma, Notion and Miro to collaborate and, Slack and Google Meet for communication. If you're building a tangible product, there's only so much you can do virtually. Despite the risk of getting COVID ourselves, eventually, we stepped out there taking all the precautions, sourced materials and built an MVP (minimum viable product). After multiple rounds of iterations and in-house testing, we conducted successful pilots at Aysha hospital, Hotel Cenneys Gateway and PES University. We also got the product certified at an ICMR-empanelled lab. We have installed the product in 5 hospitals across Tamil Nadu and are looking to reach more hospitals across India to create a greater impact." When asked if



UVfy cleaning setups installed in a lift